

# Burners Referee Guide

*How the world pushes back. The players say what they do; this is the toolkit for everything they do it to — the passage of time, the dark closing in, and the first cold look of a stranger.*

Three things run most of it: the Heat gauge you drive up and down as the scene's pressure, the Turn Tracker that keeps the world's ten-minute clock honest (old-school d6 for wandering monsters, light and noise on paper), and the Reaction roll that decides how the living things take to the crew.

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## Running Heat

Heat is the crew's shared gauge and the spine of every scene — the full player rules are in [[Burners Adventure Game]]; here is how you drive it. It is the temperature of the room, not anyone's nerve: you narrate the room tightening and the number, face-up on the table, tracks it.

**Open every scene at a base**, set by how hot the room already is:

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| Base | The scene                                                    |
|------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| 3–4  | Quiet — a meet, a market, an empty road                      |
| 6    | Working — the vault, the wilderness, the parley that matters |
| 8    | Loud — the job blown, the chase, the hall on fire            |

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**Feed it.** Every shortfall on an Approach roll raises Heat — compress big misses; a botched sneak is +1 or +2, not +5. A blown roll or a hard parley feeds it the same way. You may raise it by fiat when fresh danger walks in (reinforcements, a lit lantern, the storm arriving), announced. Blows in a fight go to HP or the Monster Stack — they do **not** feed Heat. Wounds do not feed Heat; they carry their own pressure (and may fire a wandering-monster check when the scrap ends — see Turn Tracker).

**Telegraph threats to set the room.** Rough rubric: raise Heat toward the shown monster's **HD** — lower if the foe is disadvantaged, higher if it owns the situation — and that raise **floors** the gauge while the threat remains; vents cannot drop below the floor until the menace is overcome or gone. Reveal in stages and the gauge climbs with the fiction — spoor, then half-eaten kills, then the beast at full HD (a pack: summed HD, capped by chokepoints and the dark). Show the signs for slow dread; conceal them for an ambush that raises no Heat and strikes before Fuel is up instead. Its presence sets the room; its attacks still quote its own Damage. Heat is the press dish — never the Monster Stack.

**Work the valves.** Heat falls when the crew acts on the room, not on request: fell or lose a named threat, −2; remove a named source (quench the fire, learn the ward-phrase), −1 or more; a Double Sweet vents 1; a steadying word or plan you buy, −1 once a scene. Folding ends the scene and cools to the next base. Downtime — a safe camp, a town between jobs — cools to base; a job that ended loud raises the base of what follows until the crew lies low and spends coin. Carousing is maintenance, not vice.

Heat joins the enemy side as its **Initiative / press pool** (preferred: **Heat dice only** — see [[Burners Referee Guide#Monsters at speed (preferred Referee mode)]]). Climbing Heat makes them a little faster and lets them press quotes; it does not hand you a second PC-scale dice puzzle. Finish it or fold.

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# Running the Delve

The exploration turn is one World Turn — ten minutes. Each turn runs the same short loop:

1. **Declare.** The party names a primary action for the turn — move, search, listen, force, rest, interact, or something else.
2. **Present the Scene.** Frame the place in three strokes — Scene, Oddity, Risk (below). One vivid image, one thing that begs to be poked, one reason to hesitate.
3. **Resolve.** Play out the action: movement, searching, talk, a forced door, a fight.
4. **Advance the clock.** Mark the Turn on the Turn Tracker (below). Tick light. Check for wandering monsters when the schedule or a bang calls for it. Update ongoing spells, conditions, and any other clocks the fiction demands.

Between turns the loop just repeats: frame, resolve, advance.

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## Searching and Traps

Searching costs a Turn. What it buys depends on what they tell you they are doing.

1. **Intent and method.** “We search the room” is a Turn spent and a rough look. “I run my knife along the seam under the sill” is a specific act on a specific thing, and it gets a specific answer.
2. **Give the information.** Anything a careful person would notice in ten minutes, they notice — no roll. The scratched flagstone, the draft, the tool marks, the chest whose lid sits a finger too high. You are not hiding facts; you are charging time for them.
3. **Roll only if it is still uncertain.** When the method might work and might not, it is  $2d6 + \text{Craft}$  vs the Cost. When the method plainly works on that problem, it works. When it plainly does not — bare hands on a masterwork lock — say so and let them spend the Turn elsewhere.

A trap the party has been told about is a puzzle, not a gotcha (see [[Burners Principles#No gotchas]]). Spring it undetected only when they walked past the sign or never looked. The trap quotes flat Damage — armor soaks on the way in, no Fuel up out of combat.

Mark the Turn either way. A fruitless search still burns light and still feeds the wandering-monster schedule.

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## Scene, Oddity, Risk

Every room, encounter, or travel scene should answer three questions. Build it in thirty seconds and it will run itself.

**Scene — what do they immediately perceive?** One or two sentences, no backstory: one memorable image and one dominant sense. The players should instantly know where they are.

**Oddity — what invites investigation?** More than something strange: something that begs to be touched, examined, talked to, experimented with, circumvented, or asked about. The players should think “what’s going on here?” If they can ignore it without a second thought, it is not a strong enough oddity.

**Risk — what makes that investigation uncertain?** Every interesting choice carries a possible cost: monsters, traps, hazards, time pressure, noise, resource drain, social fallout, a moral bind. The risk need not trigger at once, but it must be real. The players should think “how do we approach this?”

**The test.** If a scene has no curiosity, no meaningful interaction, and no consequence, it is just scenery — rewrite it. Run the checklist: can I picture it? do I want to investigate it? do I hesitate before I do? Three yeses and the scene is ready.

*Example — Scene: a rope bridge spans a mist-filled chasm. Oddity: every rope has been cleanly cut, yet the bridge still hangs in the air. Risk: crossing or closely examining it wakes whatever holds it aloft.*

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## Turn Tracker

A world Turn is ten minutes. Track Turns on paper where the players can see it. Number them **1 through 6**, then wrap back to **1** — six Turns is an hour, and a torch burns exactly one cycle. Even turns (2, 4, 6) are when the schedule comes round; the count itself tells you, so write nothing for the check. Write noise if they made any — ! for noise, !! for extra noise. Shouting, kicking in doors, fighting, casting spells, and the like all count. Note light and what happened.

The paper holds what the characters themselves know: time spent, noise made, light burning low, and what they did with the Turn. It is a log of the delve, not a record of your procedure.

When the count wraps, an hour has passed — a torch is spent, a lantern marks one of its four. Mark the wrap in the margin if you like (h2, h3) so absolute delve length stays visible without an endless turn count. There is no required rest Turn. If the crew wants to recover HP, that is an `[[Burners Adventure Game#Wounds|Hour Rest]]`: a full cycle spent quiet, with food and water, and no Wound on the Burner who rests. Even turns still fire during a rest hour unless the place is truly safe.

```
1  enter, listen at the door
2  Bellamy lantern lit (24)
3  ! forced the grate – the screech carries
4  long hall, water dripping somewhere ahead
5  search the shrine
6  !! fight in the nave · lantern out
– hour –
1  bind wounds in the dark
2  feeling along the north wall
```

## Wandering monsters (1-in-6)

Every check is the same: roll **1d6**, and a **1** finds something. What changes is **how often** you roll. Each signature is a reason to pick up the die:

- **Time** — even turns (2, 4, 6); the dungeon breathing
- **Noise** — when you write ! or !!; roll now
- **Dark** — when light fails; roll now
- **Wounds** — when a fight ends and someone is Wounded; roll now

So on turn 2 you roll once for time. If they then yell, you roll again for noise — another 1-in-6, not a bigger pool. A bloody scrap in the dark that ends with the lantern dead can throw three or four dice across the beat, each its own 1-in-6. The chance never climbs past “one in six”; the crew just hears the die more often.

One roll per trigger. A bang on an even turn is two rolls (time, then noise), not one combined pool — unless a check has already put an encounter on the table. Once the fight is the scene, logging !! for the scrap does not buy another wandering roll for that same scrap; wounds still fire when the fight *ends* if someone is Wounded.

Write nothing for the check. The turn number already tells you when the schedule comes round, and a bang is its own reminder — so the paper never has to say “the dungeon rolled for you.” What the players get is the sound of the die and, when it lands, something coming down the hall. If you want the moment on the log, write what the place did — *water stops dripping, a door closes two rooms off* — not that you checked.

When an encounter lands, set distance and warning from the fiction (or the module), roll Reaction if the thing can parley, and build it per Building and Running Monsters (below).

Whatever comes was already doing something before the dice said so. Say what in one breath — patrolling, hunting, hauling a kill, fleeing something worse, arguing over spoils, lost. That one line turns a roll into a clue about the place, and it usually tells you the Reaction before you roll it.

## Light

Track burn on the paper — do not hide it behind a die.

- **Torch:** 30' for 1 hour — one full cycle (6 Turns). Bundle of 6: 1 gp, 1 slot ([[Burners Equipment]]).
  - **Lantern:** 30' for 4 hours (24 Turns / four cycles) per flask. Lantern 10 gp; oil 2 gp; 1 slot each.
  - **Candle:** 5' for 1 hour — one cycle. Bundle of 6: 1 gp, 1 slot.
  - **Rag-on-a-stick:** as candle, up to ~20 minutes if lucky. Free, 1 slot.
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## The Grind — Supplies, Fatigue

Light lives on the Turn Tracker. Fatigue is why the party cannot crawl forever — a long crawl tightens the *room*, so it feeds Heat the same way any mounting pressure does. When the fiction calls for a grind tick (long haul, thin air, lingering too long), raise the gauge, usually +1, and it rides there until the crew vents it. Supplies (rations, water, ammunition) run down the same way when you say they should. An Hour Rest on the tracker (a full quiet cycle with food and water) is how unwounded Burners fill HP — see [[Burners Adventure Game#Wounds]] — not a tax for failing to sit every hour.

A Journeyman keeps the band fresh. The [[Burners Adventure Game|Journeyman's craft]] reduces party-wide travel, weather, and survival costs by the Journeyman's Craft level, and fatigue in the dark is a survival cost like any other. Subtract the Journeyman's Craft from the tick for everyone they are leading: Craft 1 shrugs off a routine +1 entirely. Fatigue bites when the party has no Journeyman, when the Journeyman is down or split off from the group, or when the place is harsh enough to outrun their level. Scale the tick to the dungeon — a mild crawl adds 1, a brutal one (heat, thin air, crushing dark) adds 2 or 3, so a Journeyman's Craft matters more the worse the ground gets.

The over-extended party is the danger this builds: the grind pushes Heat up even when nothing is attacking, so a crew that lingers, lost and tired, walks into the next fight against a hotter scene — the enemy rolling a deeper pool and acting first. “We're worn thin and the room's boiling, and nothing's even swung at us yet — we have to get out” is the pressure a long crawl builds even when nobody has taken a wound.

## Cooling off — and how HP comes back

Heat cools when the crew acts on the room (see Running Heat). HP and Wounds follow [[Burners Adventure Game#Wounds]]:

- **Full HP closes wounds.**
- **Hour Rest** (one hour, food and water) fills HP to maximum **only if you have no Wound**.
- **Wounded: 1 HP per day** with food until full, then the Wound closes. Vitae / *Stanch* / potions can help; *Healing Touch* does not restore at 0 HP or less.
- **First aid** (Craft) tends a wound and can be the **help** for the post-fight survival check; it does not restore HP by itself.

- After a fight where you took a Wound: **help**, then **2d6 + Craft vs severity** — or die. Monster specials (spawn, etc.) if you die from that creature's attack.

**Classic Crawl** (optional): see [[Burners Adventure Game#Healing and recovery]] — session zero.

## Fallen Wounds

Any of the Fallen that **wounds** you opens a **Fallen Wound**. Midnight / Purge: husks deepen by **1**; major / draining Fallen deepen by 1d6 + 1d6 per drain. Full procedure: [[Burners Burn Undead#Fallen Wounds]].

## Reaction — First Impressions

Disposition is a fact of the world (see Influence in [[Burners Adventure Game|the core rules]]), and when it is not already fixed by the fiction you roll for it. Any NPC, monster, or faction the party meets fresh gets a Reaction: roll 2d6 and read the table. This is the world's own leaning at first contact — the roll only says how it starts; what you ask next is still the Two Steps.

Circumstances are the main lever. A drawn blade, a shared enemy, a debt, a standing feud, or a fearsome reputation shift the roll the way a situational modifier shifts a defend — set a plus or minus from the same bands. Where one character is plainly making the approach (the spokesperson, the one who speaks the tongue, the face of the band), add their Heart. And Sweet and Spicy ride along as always: a rolled 6 is a good twist on the meeting, a rolled 1 a complication, whatever the total.

| 2d6        | Reaction | What it means                                                                                                   |
|------------|----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2 or less  | Hostile  | It moves against you now: attack, alarm, or bolt into a worse response. A natural 2 (fumble) is always Hostile. |
| 3–5        | Wary     | Suspicion, hard words, steep terms. It would rather you were gone; push it and it turns.                        |
| 6–8        | Neutral  | Uncertain and cautious, no commitment either way — the most open to being swayed by what you do next.           |
| 9–11       | Amiable  | Warm enough to talk, trade, or lend a hand, for a fair price or a good reason.                                  |
| 12 or more | Friendly | It takes a shine to you: real aid, a favor, the start of an ally. A natural 12 (perfect) is always Friendly.    |

Roll once at first meeting. Re-roll only when something material changes the footing: they save its life, they are caught in a lie, the faction hears what they did in the last town. A creature with no capacity for parley — mindless undead, a beast in a killing frenzy, a construct bound to its orders — skips the roll and does what its nature dictates; the table is for anything that can, in principle, be dealt with.

Reaction sets the starting disposition; the Two Steps and Influence carry the specific asks from there. A Friendly guard still will not hand you the keys to the vault, but he might look the other way where a Hostile one raises the cry.

## Frequency — running hot or cool

The default Turn Tracker (count 1–6 and wrap, a check on even turns, plus a roll whenever noise, dark, or wounds fire) is classic dungeon tempo. Loud, dark, bloody crawls hear the die more often and feel the pressure. If a job should run hotter, check every turn. If cooler, only bang-check on ! !.

### Delve Die (optional alternate clock)

If you want one 2d6 instead of the signature 1-in-6 checks, use this — **not both**. Light still ticks on the Turn Tracker every Turn; the die does not burn torches. Signature stacking (noise, dark, wounds as extra rolls) does not apply while you run this clock.

Roll 2d6, add nothing. Read the 1s and the 6s, not the sum.

- Any **1** → encounter. The other die is lead time (1,1 ambush through 1,6 distant drop).
- A **6** and no 1 → a break (safe nook, shortcut, omen, cache). Double 6 is a real gift.
- Neither → a grind tick on supplies or fatigue if the fiction calls for it (see The Grind) — not a second light tick.

Roll every Turn for a hot dungeon, or every other Turn for a cooler one. Distant 1,5 / 1,6 can be a sighting the party slips away from.

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## Building and Running Monsters

A monster is any enemy: Hit Dice, attacks, and a public **Monster Stack** of  $2 \times \text{HD}$  playing cards (face-down closed / face-up open). Its Hit Dice are its level: most humans are 0, most orcs are 1, a veteran higher. **HD 0** still gets **1 face-up card** — do not deal an empty stack. How blows land on that stack: this section. Burner-side Fuel economy: [[Burners Principles#Pools, not fixed numbers]].

### Monsters at speed (preferred Referee mode)

**Monsters have Hit Dice.** Deal each monster a **Monster Stack** of  $2 \times \text{HD}$  playing cards. **Face-down** = **closed** (armored / shell). **Face-up** = **open** (meat). Ignore rank and suit. The stack replaces notepad HP. Players like a fat Fuel pool; you keep the enemy side **small and quotable**.

**Pool = Heat only** (one dish for the whole enemy side). Roll it for Initiative (count of 3s and 4s) and as optional Fuel when you **press**. Heat is not durability — never pluck it for damage. Set it from the shown threat:  $\approx \text{HD}$ , down if the foe is on the back foot, up if it owns the fight.

**Free attack (quote).** Flat damage — no die from the pool.

| Fiction                                   | Quote  |
|-------------------------------------------|--------|
| Light (dagger, claw d4)                   | 2      |
| Common (sword, claw d6, tentacle+cutlass) | 2 or 3 |
| Heavy (d8, axe, crab smash)               | 4      |
| Huge (d10+, ogre, polearm-beast)          | 5      |

**Paint (mix inside  $2 \times \text{HD}$ ).** Naked / sushi / tough hide with no kit → **all face-up**. Soft kit (leather, shield) → **some face-down** (orc HD 1 → **1 down / 1 up**). Mail/heavier → more face-down. True shell/plate/scales → **mostly or all face-down** (crab HD 3 → **6 face-down**). Soft armor **adds face-downs into the mix** — it does not invent a flat soak or a second track outside  $2 \times \text{HD}$ .

## One blow:

1. Player announces **damage**. Keep the big number.
2. **Hits** =  $\lceil \text{damage} \div 5 \rceil$  (always round up).
3. **Closed?** (any face-down remains, or flesh that shrugs their edge) → **-1 Hit**, always. Armor is one card of soak — -5 damage in effect. No spend waives it.
4. **Right tool** — the player claims it in fiction (*“I slice the sushi!”* / *“poleax on the shell!”*) and burns **one extra Fuel** into the blow (beyond the weapon’s usual dice); its face **adds** to damage before rounding. A deeper blow, not a waiver.
5. Pop **face-down first, then face-up. 0** → bounce.

| Damage | Hits | Closed (-1) | Open |
|--------|------|-------------|------|
| 1–5    | 1    | 0           | 1    |
| 6–10   | 2    | 1           | 2    |
| 11–15  | 3    | 2           | 3    |
| 16–20  | 4    | 3           | 4    |

**Cracked!** = last face-down gone — faces show; the armor -1 ends. **Dead** = stack empty; scoop.

**Tactics:** claim the right tool for the extra die when it matters — the player holds the story. Scraps after Cracked. A **1+2** is still 1 Hit (ceil); closed → bounce; the right tool’s extra die is how a stuck blow punches through.

**Press (optional).** Burn a Heat die onto a quote when it matters.

**Many bodies (hordes / swarms).** Shared Heat dish. Attacks = bodies in reach — each its own quote (or up to two dice if you run full-dice), each Defended and soaked separately. One **Monster Stack** (2 × HD cards) per body; soft kit only changes the face mix. Fat stacks for solos and named threats. A chokepoint caps how many reach you; kill one and the bundle loses its attacks. Keeping blows separate is deliberate: one combined Damage would blow past armor; many small hits grind Fuel first. See also Swarms below for the Burner-facing read.

**Shambling** → act last.

**Full-dice monsters (optional).** Solo duel / demo as a Burner. Default is speed mode.

Retired notes: experiments/burners-monster-stacks.md (paint examples) and experiments/burners-cracked.md (legacy quote sheet).

## Morale — when the other side quits

Scores port from OSE unchanged (2–12, rolled on 2d6, roll under the score to hold). What matters at the table is remembering to ask. Check at these moments, once each:

- the side takes its **first death**
- the side is down to **half** its bodies, or a solo is **Cracked**
- the **leader** falls, flees, or is plainly beaten
- something lands that the creature has no answer to — fire on a beast, silver on the thing silver is for, a working it cannot shake

A failed check is not always flight. Read it off the fiction: run, surrender, bargain, drop the loot and scatter, or fall back to a defensible spot and keep watching. Animals bolt; disciplined troops withdraw in order; the desperate beg. Mindless things — husks, constructs, a beast in frenzy — skip Morale entirely and fight to the last card, which is exactly what makes them frightening.

When a side breaks, the threat is overcome for Heat purposes even if the bodies are still on the table. Vent, then decide whether the party gives chase (see Retreat and Pursuit).

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## Situational Damage Modifiers

The Referee raises or lowers Damage for the situation. Set a value from the band, or roll a swing die when the moment is chaotic. Narrate the cause so players can attack the reason.

| Band | Feel            | Examples                                        |
|------|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| +1   | slight edge     | bad footing, downhill, a mild distraction       |
| +2   | clear advantage | from behind, flanked, foe in the dirt, grappled |
| +3   | strong          | surprised, blinded, struck mid-cast             |
| +4   | severe          | pinned, ambushed in the dark, several stacked   |
| +5   | dire            | helpless while the fight still rages            |

The defender's edge runs the same band the other way: partial cover is a 2, hard cover a 4, an attacker who is in the dirt or swinging blind gives you a 2 or 3. When a blow outruns the dice a defender can burn (a lone die, or as many as they like once they have meleed this round; two vs a missile with Cover) plus their armor, the excess lands on HP — and past 0 it cuts a score.

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## Swarms

Foes piling onto one Burner are the player-facing read of **Many bodies** above: one quote (or blow) per body in reach, each Defended and soaked separately. Three orcs on Aldric are three attacks, not one big one. Once Aldric has meleed this round he Defends without limit against all of them; until then each blow is one die. An ally may **Block** for him (spend one melee attack to redirect one blow onto themselves). The danger is more attacks than dice — break line of sight, fight from a chokepoint, raise a shield as Cover, or thin the mob.

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## Retreat and Pursuit

Running is a real option and it needs a real procedure, or the table will fight to the death out of habit. When the crew calls a retreat, work it in this order.

**Name the destination.** Not “we run” — *where*. The stair, the spiked door two rooms back, the coal chute, daylight. If they cannot name it, they do not know the way out, and that is the answer.

**Take the roles.** Someone leads (they know the route), someone holds the rear (one Burner at a chokepoint buys the rest a beat), and someone carries what is being carried. A body cannot do two of these.

**Name the price.** Retreat always costs something, said out loud before the dice: the strongbox left behind, a dropped torch, a lantern that gutters, the wounded man's pace, the door they cannot spike in time. Let them choose which cost they pay when there is a choice.



**Then the pursuers.** Not everything follows. Ask what the thing wants. Territorial beasts stop at the border; scavengers stop at the dropped food or the dropped gold; hunters follow while the trail is loud; the truly relentless follow until stopped. State the stop condition first, then let the crew try to meet it — bar the door, drop the meat, kill the light, go quiet.

Kit earns its slots here. **Spikes and wedges** turn a door into a clock; **oil** turns a corridor into a wall; **caltrops and dropped coin** buy beats from the greedy; going dark buys everything if the pursuer hunts by sight. A retreat that spends gear and light is a good retreat, not a failure.

Mark the Turn, and mark it loud — a flight is !! on the tracker. Heat does not vent for running; it vents when the threat is behind them and the door is shut.

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## Cover, Sparks, and shooting into the press

Fuel is rolled face-up. Everyone can see the 6s.

When a missile flies into a melee, the target may use a **melee foe as Cover** (see [[Burners Adventure Game]]). If they Fuel a Spark on that Defend, the shot hits that foe instead — often a Burner locked with them. That is the rule working as written, not a gotcha to spring cold.

Before the arrow goes: give a friendly warning. *“Are you sure you want to put that into the press? He’s got a Spark sitting right there.”* The player still chooses. You telegraphed the risk while the dice were already on the table. See [[Burners Principles#No gotchas]].

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## Coming Back — Restocking

A place the party left is not a place on pause. When they return, the dungeon has reacted; it has not reset. Cleared rooms stay cleared and hard-won ground stays won — but the site answers what was done to it. Ask four questions and change only what they touch.

**Who survived, and what did they learn?** The ones who lived move the treasure, post a watch on the way the party came in, block the coal chute, or bring in help. A crew that fought loud at the entry stair finds the entry stair guarded.

**Who moved in?** Cleared space does not stay empty long. Something smaller creeps up from below, something larger claims the good room, scavengers work the corpses the party left. The new tenant is usually weaker than what was killed — the place is diminished, not restored.

**What pressure advanced?** Whatever the site was doing while nobody watched — a ritual further along, water risen another foot, a fungus spread down the hall, a faction’s dig deeper. One thing, not five.

**What scars show?** The spiked door still bears its spikes. The burned hall still stinks. The bodies are gone but the stains are not. Show one piece of their own work back to them; it is the cheapest way to make the world feel remembered.

How much changes rides on how long they were gone and how loudly they left. A day or two and a quiet exit: watches posted, little else. A week and a bloody exit: new tenants, moved treasure, and someone hunting the crew by name. Between jobs a loud site raises the base Heat of the next visit until the crew lies low (see Running Heat).

Do this at the door, not room by room. Three lines in your notes before the session is the whole procedure.

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# The Safe Town

The party begins in a safe town, which is a haven but not a home base and not theirs. It offers lodging, food, supplies, law, healing, and rumors: a place to cool off, re-equip, mend wounds, and hear where trouble lies. The party are guests on someone else's ground, and the town has its own authorities and life. Adventures spiral out from it and back to it, and a party may later earn or build a true home base of their own.

**Level here.** XP banks in the field; characters spend it to gain a level only in civilization — this town, another haven, or a place where they can train and rest. Mid-delve rank-ups do not happen. Rare emergencies are your call.

**Exploration crumbs (optional).** A small XP award for a wilderness hex newly mapped or a dungeon room meaningfully explored rewards poking and mapping without replacing treasure. Tune the number; there is no fixed crumb.

**Inventing spells and items.** When a player wants a working or lasting item not in the catalog, treat it as a campaign project: time, rare materials, a teacher or ruin, and a clear failure mode. No price table. Arcana stay finds; research may yield a scroll or potion formula, or a one-off the table invents together. See [[Burners Sorcerie]].

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## Pricing Unlisted Gear

When an item is not on the [[Burners Equipment]] tables, price it from its slots and category, then adjust for quality and rarity and add it to the list. Listed gear uses the Equipment prices. The rates below are for **unlisted** pieces.

- Common gear (clothing, tools, a waterskin): 1 gp per slot.
- Fine steel and specialty goods (books, lockpicks, instruments, specialty tools): 10 gp per slot.
- Plain armaments (odd weapons not on the list): 5 gp per slot.
- Provisions: 1 gp per meal for the group.
- Ranged weapons and special materials such as silver add a surcharge when you invent a new piece.
- Arcana have no shop price — found, seized, gifted, or inherited. Scrolls and potions are downtime craft at 100 gp × spell level (see [[Burners Sorcerie]]).
- Heavy or exceptional armaments run far dearer: about 100 gp for a +1 grade, 1,000 gp for a rare +2 (added on a listed or formula price).
- Elevated quality adds to any item: +10 gp for fine, +100 for rich, +1,000 for noble work.
- Magic items are rarely for sale at any price; you decide whether one can be found at all. Stocking enchanted arms: [[Burners Referee Magic Items]].